



OpenClaw Docker Installation – Version 2026.02.27

0) Quick Pre-Check — 02/28/2026

- Docker Desktop installed and running
 - WSL Integration enabled (integrated with your Ubuntu)
 - Ollama installed and running
-

1) Open UBUNTU

Search for **Ubuntu** in the Windows search bar.

From this point on, all commands are executed inside the Ubuntu (WSL) terminal.

2) Clone OpenClaw (official repo) and enter the folder

```
cd ~  
git clone https://github.com/openclaw/openclaw  
cd openclaw
```

(The official Docker setup lives inside the repo and uses their compose configuration.)

3) Run the official Docker setup

```
chmod +x ./docker-setup.sh  
./docker-setup.sh
```

This script prepares the Docker/Compose environment and creates persistent mounts/folders (config/workspace).

4) Run the onboard (wizard) via CLI inside the container

```
docker compose run --rm openclaw-cli onboard
```

⚠ Note: In newer versions, the setup may start automatically and this step might not be required.

This generates/updates the openclaw.json and configures provider/channels properly.

4.1) Configure Ollama (running on Windows, OpenClaw in Docker)

Base URL (OpenAI-compatible):

```
http://host.docker.internal:11434/v1
```

⚠ **Crucial tip for your case (Local Ollama + Docker):**

If Ollama runs on Windows and OpenClaw runs inside Docker, the correct and most common host is:

host.docker.internal

(This is the standard way for a container to access a service running on the host.)

5) Start the gateway

```
docker compose up -d openclaw-gateway
```

(In some flows the service name may vary, but the documentation uses this example.)

6) Open the Control UI and paste the token

Paste the token into the URL (it will look like this):

```
http://localhost:18789/#token=YOUR_TOKEN_HERE
```

7) If you get “pairing required (1008)”

(MOST COMMON ERROR IN NEWER VERSIONS)

Symptom:

The dashboard opens but shows “Disconnected from gateway”, and you see:

- pairing required
- in logs: code=1008 reason=pairing required

✓ Working Solution (Manual Browser Approval)

7.1) Confirm the gateway is “Up”

```
docker compose ps
```

7.2) Enter the gateway container

⚠ Important: inside the container, Docker does not exist — do NOT run docker compose inside it.

```
docker compose exec openclaw-gateway sh
```

(If bash exists, you can use bash, but sh works everywhere.)

Your prompt will change to something like:

```
node@<container>: /app$
```

7.3) List pending devices (pairing requests)

Inside the container:

```
node dist/index.js devices list
```

You will see something like:

- Pending (1) → with a Request ID
- Paired (1) → already approved devices

7.4) Approve the Request ID from “Pending”

Still inside the container:

```
node dist/index.js devices approve <requestId>
```

Example:

```
node dist/index.js devices approve 2da4...d49f
```

7.5) Confirm Pending is now zero

```
node dist/index.js devices list
```

Ideally:

- Pending = 0
- Device appears under Paired

7.6) Exit the container and reconnect

```
exit
```

Go back to your browser, refresh the page (F5), and click Connect.

✓ The dashboard should now show **Online**.

Important Note

Every time you open the dashboard in:

- a different browser
- a new tab
- an incognito window

...it may generate a new Pending request.

Just repeat the approve step with the new requestId.

“Sanity Check” Commands

```
docker compose ps
docker compose logs -n 200 openclaw-gateway
docker compose run --rm openclaw-cli status
```

Translated from Portuguese to English by AI.